

telling techniques. Don't look at it as a problem but an opportunity to make something interesting.

The Technical Step By Step

Across all editing software there exist a few constants - the timeline, the toolbox, the preview screen and your media folder. Some software allows for sophisticated media management which makes it easy to organise and find your footage while others let you bring each in one at a time. In either case, your basic editing environment demands an efficient sequence of steps when you're working to ensure that the technical side of filmmaking and editing doesn't burden the creative side.

The first step in any non linear editing job is the setting up of your project file. The project file is critical since it is what the application uses to organise all the information regarding your edit including the location of your source footage, the creation of thumbnails and the labelling of metadata. The project file also tells the application what medium of footage you're using - DSLR footage, cell phone footage or professional camera footage - based on the various specifics of each of these formats the project file is oriented. You can also select a lot of the fine details like frame rates, bit rates, audio frequency, refresh rates, resolution of the final file and many other details. One of the most important features here is the number of video and audio tracks in the project. Although this can be increased later on in the project it is better to start with at least three of each so you have enough room to move footage around and experiment. It is best to start with presets which are most accurate to your project.

The basic aspects to remember is that footage shot at different frame rates can look very odd when sequenced together. So if you have a mix of 24fps, 30fps, 50fps and 60fps you best convert it all to the lowest possible limit to get the most consistent view. This is unless you are intending to slow down the higher framerates or speed up the lower framerates for stylistic effects. The project file however is slave to one chosen frame rate which in movies is typically 24fps and online videos are 30fps.

Formats and Software

Most editing software can handle the most popular video formats without much problem. But many of the free to use or open source editing tools have limitations on RAW and proprietary formats. Its important to know what footage formats your camera produces when its shooting. In most DSLRs